

The Last Lecture

Prof. J. Alberto Espinosa

Dept. of Information Technology & Analytics

alberto@american.edu

November 21, 2025



KOGOD SCHOOL of BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC

Topics

The Last Lecture Tradition

My Journey

Analytics & AI (MS, UG, Business)

Reflections on Scholarship

Reflections on Service

Reflections on Teaching

About Ranks

Faculty Recruitment, Development & Retention

Maintaining the Kogod Community

Are we having fun?

The Last Lecture Tradition



KOGOD SCHOOL *of* BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC

The Last Lecture Tradition

*“If you were asked to give the **last lecture** of your life to your colleagues and students, what would you tell them?”*

Prof. Randy Pausch

Video:

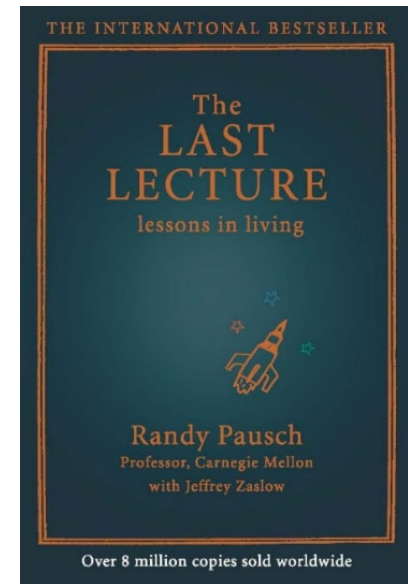
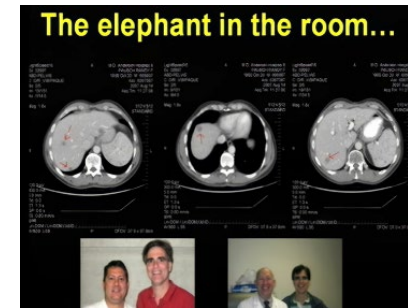
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ayPMfopCelg&t=3800s> (>21M views)

Book:

<https://www.amazon.com/dp/B00SLSWEQ6> (>5M sold)

Alice:

<https://www.alice.org>



A

My Journey



KOGOD SCHOOL *of* BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC

Analytics & AI (MS, UG, Business)



KOGOD SCHOOL of BUSINESS
by POETS & QUANTS



MS in BUSINESS ANALYTICS ONLINE
by FORTUNE



MS in BUSINESS ANALYTICS
in the US by QS



MS in ANALYTICS ONLINE
by US NEWS & WORLD REPORT

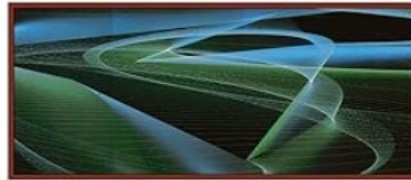


KOGOD SCHOOL of BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC

In the Age of the Smart Machine (1989)

**IN THE AGE
OF THE SMART
MACHINE**

**THE FUTURE OF
WORK AND POWER**



SHOSHANA ZUBOFF

WSJ

How to Make Sure ChatGPT Doesn't Make You Dumber

Generative AI tools are quietly weakening our cognitive skills. Here are four ways to keep that from happening.

By Paul Rust and Nina Vasan

Sept. 3, 2025 2:04 pm ET



KOGOD SCHOOL of BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC



Business Analytics

“It is the scientific process of transforming data into insights for making better decisions” (INFORMS)

Lack analytical talent – by **2018**, the US would face a shortage of **140,000** to **190,000** people with **deep analytical skills** and **1.5 million managers** with analytical skills to make decisions with data (McKinsey Global Institute, **2011**)



The Age of Analytics
McKinsey Global Institute
2016



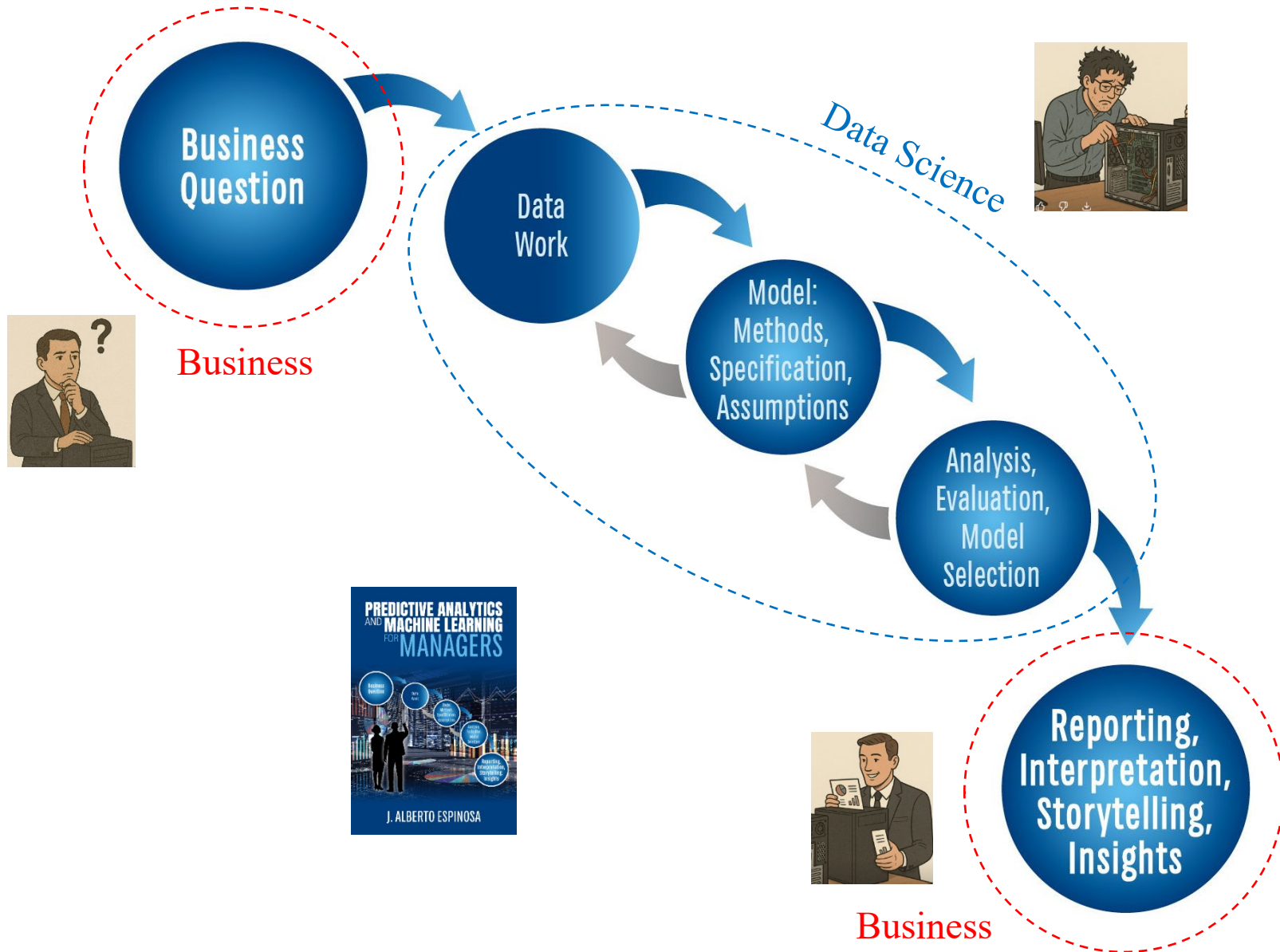
2M-4M

Projected US demand for
“**business translators**” in
the **2020** decade

High demand for **business translators** → people who serve as the **link** between **data science** talent and business applications and **managers**, who are business-savvy and can answer business questions.

In **2025** McKinsey issued their “**AI in the Workplace**” report, stating that employers are eager to adopt AI, but leadership and readiness in this area lag behind → Almost **all** companies invest in **AI**, but just **1%** believe they lack **leaders** who understand AI.

The Analytics Process



Reflections on Scholarship



KOGOD SCHOOL *of* BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC



Scholarship Summary:

8,000+ Google Scholar Citations

18 Peer-Reviewed Articles + 40 Conference Proceedings

3 Books and 9 Book Chapters

Kogod Outstanding Research Awards 2004, 07, 08, 10, 11, 13, 15, 18, and 19

Focus: team coordination, geographic dispersion, team knowledge



Journals: [JMIS \(5\)](#), [IEEE TSE](#), [ISR](#), [Org Sci](#), [Mgt Sci](#), [CACM](#), IEEE TEM (3), IJSSOE, Human Factors, IT&P, JSPPI, Heliyon

Co-Authors: [Lee](#), [Delone](#), [Carmel](#), [Clark](#), [Armour \(Kogod\)](#); Slaughter, Kraut, Herbsleb (CMU); Wilson, Pearce (CMU); Möckli, Simon, Meyer-Masseti, Zuñiga (Basel U); Armour, Boh (Nanyang); Nordback (Aalto U), Kaisler, Money; Nan (UBC); Cummings (Duke), Pickering (Intel); Gopal (UM Smith), Gosain, Darcy; Dubinsky (IBM)





Reflections on Service



KOGOD SCHOOL *of* BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC

Service Summary:

Kogod Award for Outstanding Service in 2010, 11, 12, 14, 14, 15, 16, 19, 21, and 24

Kogod Dean's Special Award for Outstanding Service, 2014

Architected and Implemented:

- MS Analytics, campus and online
- UG specializations and minor in Business Analytics and IST

Most important service: faculty recruitment



Reflections on Teaching



KOGOD SCHOOL *of* BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC

Taught over 2,200 students over 24 years

American University's 2025 Outstanding Teaching in Full-Time Appointment Award

2021-22 Kogod Graduate Professor of the Year Award

2020-21 American University Green Teacher of the Year

Kogod Award for Outstanding Teaching in 2011, 12, 19, 22, and 24.



KOGOD SCHOOL *of* BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC

Faculty Recruitment, Development & Retention



KOGOD SCHOOL *of* BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC

Community & Traditions



KOGOD SCHOOL *of* BUSINESS
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY • WASHINGTON, DC

Traditions:

- Kogod Case Competition
- Kogod IT's A Carnival and IT Review Competition
- Bill DeLone's volleyball
- Tepper's Management Game
- Tepper's Friday Beers
- Texas Tech's faculty seminar, Syracuse's paper reading roundtable



ITR Fall 2007 (First)

